

WEEK 2 ASSIGNMENT PRESENTATION

Product Lifecycle Mastery

From Idea to Market — Understanding the Full Journey of a Product

The Five Topics

01

Idea Validation

Is this worth building?

02

MVP Concept

Build the smallest thing that works

03

Product-Market Fit

Did we get it right?

04

Iteration Cycles

How do we improve?

05

Growth Stages

Where is the product now?

01 — Idea Validation

Is this worth building?

Core Question

Does this problem exist, and are people frustrated enough to solve it?

Real Example

Someone says: "Let's build an app for students to track their SIWES log automatically."

Before building: Do students struggle with this? Are supervisors complaining? Could WhatsApp solve it instead?

VALIDATION METHODS



Talk to 5–10 real users before writing a single line of code



Run a simple survey — Google Forms costs nothing



Build a fake landing page and see if people sign up



Look for workarounds — if people use Excel or WhatsApp for it, the problem exists

02 — MVP Concept

Minimum Viable Product

If you want to build a car, your MVP is not half a car with no wheels — it's a bicycle. It solves the transportation problem while you learn if people want to go faster.

Real Example — Instagram

Instagram's MVP did ONE thing: apply filters to photos and share them. No reels, no stories, no shopping. They proved people loved it, then built everything else.

Common Mistakes to Avoid

- ✗ Adding features "just in case" — wastes time and money
- ✗ Confusing MVP with prototype — different purposes
- ✗ Waiting until it's "perfect" — done beats perfect

PRACTICAL TASK

Write a one-paragraph MVP description for a student logbook app. What does version 1 do? What does it deliberately NOT do yet?

03 — Product-Market Fit

Did we get it right?

The Sean Ellis Test

Ask users: "How would you feel if you could no longer use this product?"

If 40%+ say 'very disappointed' — you likely have PMF.

No PMF Signs

- Users sign up but don't return
- You must constantly convince people
- People say 'nice' but won't refer

Real Example — WhatsApp

People in Nigeria, India, and Brazil were paying \$1/year for WhatsApp even when SMS was free. The product fit the market's need so well that people paid for what was free elsewhere.

PMF Signs

- ✓ Users tell others without being asked
- ✓ They're upset when the app is down
- ✓ Organic growth without ad spend

PRACTICAL TASK — For your X3 Lab study: Did the initiative achieve PMF? How do you know? What evidence exists — user numbers, feedback, repeat usage?

04 — Iteration Cycles

How do we improve?



↻ This loop repeats — continuously

KEY ITERATION TOOLS

User Feedback

Surveys, interviews, complaint tracking

Analytics

Which features do people actually use?

A/B Testing

Show version A to half, version B to rest — pick the winner

Real Example — Your Phone's Apps

Every app update on your phone is the result of one iteration cycle. Developers watched how you used the app, saw where you got confused or stopped, and fixed it.

For your X3 Lab study: How many versions did the initiative go through? What triggered each change?

PRACTICAL TASK — Pick any app. Find two past updates in the store. Write one sentence each explaining what problem that update was likely solving.

05 — Growth Stages

Where is the product now?

Introduction	Growth	Maturity	Decline	Renewal
Getting first users	Scaling & fixing	Retain, differentiate	Pivot or shut down	Reinvent the product

Real Example — BlackBerry

Introduction in 2000s → Growth with BBM → Maturity as smartphones rose → Decline when Android/iPhone took over → Attempted Renewal by switching to software.

All 5 stages — one company.

Real Example — Facebook / Meta

Facebook is in the Maturity stage in the West — growth has slowed, so they focus on retention. To find Growth, they acquired WhatsApp and Instagram — new markets, new products.

PRACTICAL TASK

Name 5 real Nigerian or African products/apps — place one at each growth stage and explain why in one sentence.

X3 Lab Initiative Study

From Idea to Delivery

01 Lifecycle Stages

Map each stage the initiative went through — Idea, Validation, MVP, Growth, etc.

02 Missing Systems

Identify gaps — what tools, processes, or feedback loops were absent?

03 Current Stage

Where is the initiative now? Justify using evidence, not guesswork.

04 Recommendations

What should happen next based on the lifecycle stage it is in?

Your lifecycle map is the key deliverable — it shows you can think like a product manager, not just a student.

5 Questions

1

What is the difference between an MVP and a prototype?

2

30 out of 100 users say they'd be 'very disappointed' if your student portal shut down. Do you have PMF? Why or why not?

3

Name the 5 growth stages in order. Place one real Nigerian or African product at each stage.

4

Look at your X3 Lab initiative — write 3 bullet points on what lifecycle stage it's in and why.

5

What is one missing system in the initiative, and what lifecycle stage does fixing it belong to?

Key Takeaway

Understanding the product lifecycle is not just theory — it's how great products get built.

Every product you will ever build or manage will follow these stages. The best product managers don't guess — they know which stage they're in and act accordingly.